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Chapter 3

Enquiries



Introduction To Enquiries

The Sales Analysis enquiry function is extremely flexible in that you define the views of the database which you require, and the information which you wish to see.

Enquiries are made by choosing an attribute upon which to enquire, and an attribute by which to analyse. Once a combination of attributes is known to the system, it will 'remember' it for future use, providing fast response times. The format of the information shown by the enquiry is chosen by you - which values to display, the scale of the values and the time periods for which to display the values.

Sales History Enquiry



1/STSAE

The Sales History Enquiry function enables you to create and view your own enquiries on the Sales History Database.

The procedure consists of:

Select Enquiry Attributes screen

Create Enquiry screen

View Enquiry Details screen

Sales History Enquiry Screen 1

The screen lists all the attributes available for enquiry from the Sales History Database.

SA100		ST - JBA System Test Company		User GJBAMRX		7/11/95	
						9:45:22	
Sales History Enquiry							
Enquire on :				Analysed by :			
Customer.....?..	☐	Customer.....	-	Customer.....	-		
Delivery Point...?..	☐	Delivery Point.....	-	Delivery Point.....	-		
Customer Class...?..	☐	Customer Class.....	-	Customer Class.....	-		
Region.....?..	☐	Region.....	-	Region.....	-		
Salesman.....?..	☐	Salesman.....	-	Salesman.....	-		
Area.....?..	☐	Area.....	-	Area.....	-		
Depot.....?..	☐	Depot.....	-	Depot.....	-		
Item.....?..	☐	Item.....	-	Item.....	-		
Item Class.....?..	☐	Item Class.....	-	Item Class.....	-		
Item Type.....?..	☐	Item Type.....	-	Item Type.....	-		
Major Item Group...?..	☐	Major Item Group....	-	Major Item Group....	-		
Minor Item Group...?..	☐	Minor Item Group....	-	Minor Item Group....	-		
VAT Code.....?..	☐	VAT Code.....	-	VAT Code.....	-		
F3=Exit F4=Prompt							
07-24		SA	MW	KS	IM	II	KENB20A PET178S2

Fields:

Enquire On

You must choose one attribute on which to enquire, by entering a valid value for the attribute in the left hand column, and select one attribute by which to analyse, by entering a 1 against the attribute in the right hand column.

Entering a ? and pressing **F4** will provide a prompt on any attribute values.

Processing will vary depending on whether the enquiry (the combination of the two attributes), exists or not.



Press **Enter** to continue.

- If the enquiry already exists, you will be presented with the screen showing the detailed analysis of information.
- If the enquiry does not exist, you will be presented with the create prompt.

Sales History Enquiry Screen 2

This screen enables you to create a new enquiry, i.e. an analysis using two attributes not previously used.

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SA100          ST - JBA System Test Company   User GJBAMRX   7/11/95
                                                    9:49:43

Sales History Enquiry

Enquire on :                               Analysed by :
Delivery Point                             Salesman

This enquiry does not exist at present. To create it press F8.

Batch/interactive  1  (1=Batch, 2=Interactive)

Note Interactive create may render your terminal inoperable for a long period
of time. For this reason batch create is advised.

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F3=Exit  F8=Submit  F12=Previous

13-23  SF  MW  KS  IM  II  KENB20A  PET178S2
```

The two attributes chosen will be shown on the screen.

Fields:

Batch/Interactive

Enter a 1 to submit enquiry creation to batch.

Enter a 2 to create the enquiry interactively.



Tip: If you are handling large amounts of sales history data, it is advisable to create the enquiry in batch.



Press **F8=Submit** to create the enquiry.

This will generate summary files which provide the information for the enquiry. Once they have been created, these summary files will be updated by future Sales History Updates.



If the enquiry is created interactively, you will be returned to the attribute selection screen on completion. Press **Enter** to use the enquiry. If the enquiry is submitted to batch, wait for the job to complete before using the particular enquiry created.

View Sales History Enquiry Details Screen

This enables you to view the detailed analysis produced by the enquiry. The actual data displayed is determined by a combination of factors.

Essentially, the screen shows a single attribute analysed by another attribute. The customer is displayed at the top of the screen, and the items sold to the customer are listed down the screen. For each item, there are four columns of data, the content of which is determined by the enquiry format. The current content of each column in terms of time period and value is indicated on the screen.

The enquiry may be inverted, by entering a 1 against a detail line. This will then show all customers to whom the selected item is sold.

The information shown for a detail line may be displayed on a bar chart by entering a 2 against the required detail line.

You may enter the following details:

Fields:

Enquiry Attribute

A value for the attribute being enquired on may be entered at the top of the screen, in order to display an analysis for that value of the attribute.

Press **Enter** to step through the values in sequence

Format

Enter a valid format previously defined in the Sales History Time Period Selection function. This will default to 1. Selection of another format will change the information displayed in the columns to that defined for the new format.

Select Detail

You may invert the enquiry by entering a 1 in this field, or you may produce a bar chart for the appropriate detail by entering a 2 in this field.

Manipulation of the data is possible within the main enquiry screen in a number of ways:

Pressing **Enter** will step through the attribute being enquired on in sequence. You may key an actual value for the attribute, and then pressing **Enter** will present a breakdown of that value by the analysis attribute.



To provide an 'upside down' version of the enquiry, whereby the 'analysis attribute' is broken down by the 'enquire by' attribute, key a 1 alongside the required attribute.



To produce a barchart of the historical data, key a 2 against the detail line. To return from the barchart to the enquiry screen, press **Enter**.

To change the time periods shown by the enquiry, an alternative format may be used. The formats are maintained by the Sales History Period Selection function, and determine which time periods are used, and the values displayed.

You can change the values on the display, while keeping the time periods the same, by pressing **F8**. This will display a screen, showing the values available. You may select a value to be displayed by entering a 1 against it.



Press **Enter** to return to Sales History Enquiry
Screen 1.